

The Lady, or the Tiger?

Frank R. Stockton · 1882

First published: The Century, Nov 1882

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_lady,_or_the_tiger?_and_other_stories/The_Lady,_or_the_Tiger? (revision 5766637), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 6–10 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about jealousy and love?
- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about justice and chance?
- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about choice?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Common Core

RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five

Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Lady, or the Tiger?	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*jealousy and love* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Lady, or the Tiger?

Author biography

Frank R. Stockton was born in Philadelphia on 5 April 1834. He worked as a wood engraver before turning to writing, and became assistant editor of St. Nicholas, the leading American children's magazine. He wrote fairy tales and comic stories, and his puzzle story "The Lady, or the Tiger?" (1882) made him famous; readers wrote to him for decades asking for the answer, which he never gave. He died on 20 April 1902.

Historical and cultural context

Stockton wrote for a popular magazine audience in the 1880s who loved puzzles and parlour debates. The "semi-barbaric" kingdom is a fanciful, vaguely ancient setting, not a real place.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in The Century Magazine in November 1882.

Then: A sensation; readers flooded Stockton with letters demanding the answer, and he never gave one. It was discussed in debating clubs.

Now: A classic for teaching open endings and argument from evidence.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A semi-barbaric king tries accused men in an arena: behind one door is a lady to marry, behind the other a tiger. When a young man loves the princess, he is sent to the arena; she knows which door is which.

Main themes

- love versus jealousy.
- justice and chance.
- human nature.

Why it matters

It teaches students to make and defend a claim when the text does not give an answer.

Spoilers · teacher only

She signals him to the right-hand door, and the story ends without saying what came out.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)

Before we open The Lady, or the Tiger?: Would you rather see someone you love marry someone else, or die?
Prompt: Before we open The Lady, or the Tiger?: Would you rather see someone you love marry someone else, or die?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

open ending; ambiguity; irony; characterization.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Frank R. Stockton was born in Philadelphia on 5 April 1834. He worked as a wood engraver before turning to writing, and became assistant editor of St. Nicholas, the leading American children's magazine. He wrote fairy tales and comic stories, and his puzzle story "The Lady, or the Tiger?" (1882) made him famous; readers wrote to him for decades asking for the answer, which he never gave. He died on 20 April 1902. The world of the book. Stockton wrote for a popular magazine audience in the 1880s who loved puzzles and parlour debates. The "semi-barbaric" kingdom is a fanciful, vaguely ancient setting, not a real place. Publication and reception. First published in The Century Magazine in November 1882. Then: A sensation; readers flooded Stockton with letters demanding the answer, and he never gave one. It was discussed in debating clubs. Now: A classic for teaching open endings and argument from evidence.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26). The ending question.

> *Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26)*

Think-aloud: "Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26). The ending question.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): A semi-barbaric king tries accused men in an arena: behind one door is a lady to marry, behind the other a tiger. When a young man loves the princess, he is sent to the arena; she knows which door is which. Themes to track: love versus jealousy.: justice and chance.: human nature.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question.
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Lady, or the Tiger?: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does The Lady, or the Tiger? still matter? It teaches students to make and defend a claim when the text does not give an answer.
Anchor question: Why might The Lady, or the Tiger? still be taught today?
Facilitation: It teaches students to make and defend a claim when the text does not give an answer.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Which door? Give one quotation. Answer: Either is defensible: her "semi-barbaric" passion and jealousy (tiger) or her love (lady).
Exit ticket: Which door? Give one quotation.
Answer: Either is defensible: her "semi-barbaric" passion and jealousy (tiger) or her love (lady).

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: The Lady, or the Tiger?.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Frank R. Stockton" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Frank-R-Stockton); Frank R. Stockton, The Lady, or the Tiger? and Other Stories (1884) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Lesson 2: The Lady, or the Tiger?

Focus: a choice the reader must make

Content note (implied violent death): Sensitive content: Implied violent death. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes implied violent death.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling us what came out.

Background: Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered.

Significance: The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love versus jealousy because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes implied violent death.
Prompt: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love versus jealousy because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: her choice is the story.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: exuberant — joyously unrestrained; devious — indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading; gnashed — grind together, of teeth; amphitheatre — a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater); fateful — decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end.
Words: exuberant: joyously unrestrained · devious: indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading · gnashed: grind together, of teeth · amphitheatre: a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater) · fateful: decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered. The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans. Ambiguity: The ending is unresolved by design. Irony: The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice. Characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Watch for the doors: fate and choice.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "semi-barbaric king" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1). Setting. That is ambiguity at work: The ending is unresolved by design.

> *semi-barbaric king* *(The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "semi-barbaric king" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1). Setting. That is ambiguity at work: The ending is unresolved by design.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Students should say what "slight, quick" suggests: a decision already made. Ask: How does this line connect to love versus jealousy? Expected: Her choice is the story. (Her signal.)

> *She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right* *(The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Students should say what "slight, quick" suggests: a decision already made.
Ask: How does this line connect to love versus jealousy?
Expected answer: Her choice is the story. (Her signal.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the story for ambiguity, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. When the text says “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

Task: Annotate the story for ambiguity, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. When the text says “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever? Debate: lady or tiger.

Anchor question: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?

Facilitation: Debate: lady or tiger.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. ("She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right", The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. ("She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right", The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how ambiguity shapes a choice the reader must make. Key takeaway: her choice is the story.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Ambiguity:** The ending is unresolved by design.
- **Irony:** The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice.
- **Characterization:** The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous.

Themes and how they develop

- **love versus jealousy:** her choice is the story.

Symbols and motifs

- **the doors:** fate and choice.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "semi-barbaric king" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1) Setting.
- "She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17) Her signal.
- "Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26) The question.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings.
Evidence: "She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17)
Reasoning: She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
devious (adjective)	indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading	*It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
gnashed (verb)	grind together, of teeth	*How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
amphitheatre (noun)	a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)	*This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fateful (adjective)	decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end	*The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rewarded (verb)	given something good in return	*This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
premises (noun)	assumptions an argument is based on	*He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
depended (verb)	be contingent upon (something that is elided)	*Think of it, fair reader, not as if the decision of the question depended upon yourself, but upon that hot-blooded, semi-barbaric princess, her soul at a white heat beneath the combined fires of despair and jealousy.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hesitate (verb)	pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness	*He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?
2. Where does structure appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with jealousy and love?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The accused opens one of two doors
2. What is behind the two doors? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A tiger and a lady
3. Why is the princess's lover on trial? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He loved the king's daughter
4. Which door does the princess point to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The right-hand door
5. How does the story end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It asks the reader which came out
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Lady, or the Tiger?” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling us what came out.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.” What does “exuberant” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: exuberant: joyously unrestrained.
10. Reread: “It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.” What does “devious” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: devious: indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” suggest about a choice the reader must make? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.
2. Find one example of structure in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the story is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
3. How does the irony in this story shape what we understand about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. On irony: The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself.”, why might Stockton have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” set up that the rest of The Lady, or the Tiger? will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. On characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with jealousy and love? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. On characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. On characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Lady, or the Tiger?” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Lady, or the Tiger?”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to justice and chance: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Stockton need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the structure in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Lady, or the Tiger?” treats a choice the reader must make with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Lady, or the Tiger? see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve jealousy and love? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Frank R. Stockton about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the story is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt?
   A. A jury votes
   B. The accused opens one of two doors
   C. The king decides
   D. A duel
2. What is behind the two doors?
   A. Two tigers
   B. Gold and a sword
   C. A tiger and a lady
   D. A prison and freedom
3. Why is the princess's lover on trial?
   A. He loved the king's daughter
   B. He stole from the king
   C. He killed a guard
   D. He insulted the king
4. Which door does the princess point to?
   A. The right-hand door
   B. Both
   C. The left-hand door
   D. Neither
5. How does the story end?
   A. The lover marries the lady
   B. The princess frees him
   C. The tiger kills him
   D. It asks the reader which came out

6. In the line “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. grind together, of teeth
   C. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
7. In the line “It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.”, what does “devious” most nearly mean?
   A. grind together, of teeth
   B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   D. joyously unrestrained

Answer key: 1. B (The accused opens one of two doors); 2. C (A tiger and a lady); 3. A (He loved the king's daughter); 4. A (The right-hand door); 5. D (It asks the reader which came out); 6. A (joyously unrestrained); 7. B (indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Lady, or the Tiger?,” how does Stockton show a choice the reader must make? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In The Lady, or the Tiger?, how does Stockton develop the idea of a choice the reader must make? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of a choice the reader must make. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what The Lady, or the Tiger? suggests about a choice the reader must make. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's structure and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Frank R. Stockton uses structure in The Lady, or the Tiger? to complicate the reader's understanding of a choice the reader must make. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Lady, or the Tiger? within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a choice the reader must make responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Lady, or the Tiger? alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a choice the reader must make follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Lady, or the Tiger? and its treatment of a choice the reader must make. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's structure and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Lady, or the Tiger? as evidence for a larger claim about a choice the reader must make in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Lady, or the Tiger? as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a choice the reader must make. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Lady, or the Tiger?.

SAT-style questions

1. *How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “gnashed” most nearly mean?

   A. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness

   B. be contingent upon (something that is elided)

   C. grind together, of teeth

   D. assumptions an argument is based on

2. *But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself. The arena of the king was built, not to give the people an opportunity of hearing the rhapsodies of dying gladiators, nor to enable them to view the inevitable conclusion of a conflict between religious opinions and hungry jaws, but for purposes far better adapted to widen and develop the mental energies of the people. This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its*

mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Lady, or the Tiger?"?

A. The futile attempt to shut out death

B. Hope created by an act of sacrifice

C. A choice the reader must make

D. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

SAT key: 1. C (grind together, of teeth); 2. C (A choice the reader must make)

Whole-book test

The Lady, or the Tiger?: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt?
   A. A jury votes
   B. The accused opens one of two doors
   C. The king decides
   D. A duel
2. What is behind the two doors?
   A. Two tigers
   B. Gold and a sword
   C. A tiger and a lady
   D. A prison and freedom
3. Why is the princess's lover on trial?
   A. He loved the king's daughter
   B. He stole from the king
   C. He killed a guard
   D. He insulted the king
4. Which door does the princess point to?
   A. The right-hand door
   B. Both
   C. The left-hand door
   D. Neither
5. How does the story end?
   A. The lover marries the lady
   B. The princess frees him
   C. The tiger kills him
   D. It asks the reader which came out
6. In the line “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. grind together, of teeth
   C. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

7. In the line “It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.”, what does “devious” most nearly mean?
   A. grind together, of teeth
   B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   D. joyously unrestrained
8. As used in the story (“He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”), what does “exuberant” mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
   C. be contingent upon (something that is elided)
   D. grind together, of teeth
9. As used in the story (“It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.”), what does “devious” mean?
   A. given something good in return
   B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   C. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness
   D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
10. As used in the story (“How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door”), what does “gnashed” mean?
    A. assumptions an argument is based on
    B. joyously unrestrained
    C. grind together, of teeth
    D. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
11. As used in the story (“This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in wh”), what does “amphitheatre” mean?
    A. be contingent upon (something that is elided)
    B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
    C. given something good in return
    D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
12. As used in the story (“The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.”), what does “fateful” mean?
    A. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
    B. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness
    C. grind together, of teeth
    D. assumptions an argument is based on

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how jealousy and love develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

2. Explain how justice and chance develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how choice develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (jealousy and love, justice and chance, choice) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. B (The accused opens one of two doors); 2. C (A tiger and a lady); 3. A (He loved the king's daughter); 4. A (The right-hand door); 5. D (It asks the reader which came out); 6. A (joyously unrestrained); 7. B (indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading); 8. A (joyously unrestrained); 9. B (indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading); 10. C (grind together, of teeth); 11. D (a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)); 12. A (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end)

Essay assignments

Essay: Jealousy and love

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about jealousy and love. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of jealousy and love. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of jealousy and love, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of jealousy and love in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Justice and chance

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about justice and chance. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops justice and chance across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of justice and chance. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of justice and chance, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of justice and chance in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Choice

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about choice. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops choice across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of choice. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of choice, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of choice in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on choice in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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